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I'm Building an AI Chatbot on Amazon Lex!



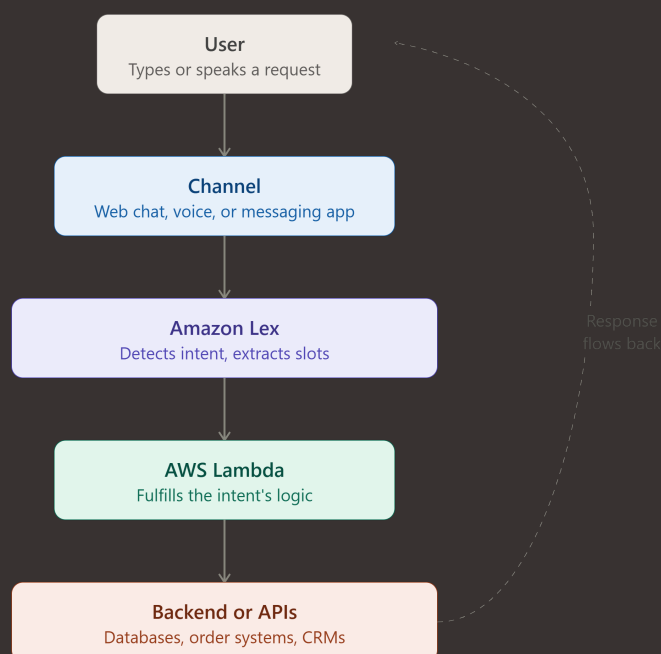
Isaiah Peter





The Project

I am building a chatbot as part of the NextWork Lex Chatbot series for several key reasons: To demonstrate my technical AI skills: I want to showcase my practical abilities to potential employers. To gain hands on AWS experience: I would be looking to work directly with AWS services beyond just studying for certifications and see AI as a growing and important offering within the AWS ecosystem. By the end of these five projects, I would have built a fully functional banking assistant, gaining experience in everything from greeting users and recognizing banking terms to retrieving account balances and saving user information.





Hold me accountable!

To ensure I successfully complete the NextWork Lex Chatbot series, I've set the following goals: * **Schedule:** I will set aside **one hour each week** to work on this project series, treating it as a dedicated learning block to maintain steady progress. * **Accountability:** I will keep myself accountable by **tracking my progress** through the project checklists and sharing my documentation on LinkedIn to engage with the community. * **Reward:** My reward for completing this series will be **adding a fully functional AI project to my professional portfolio**, which I'll proudly showcase to potential employers. I'm ready to dive into the challenges and build these skills.

What is AI in chatbots?

AI-powered chatbots use technology that teaches computers to understand and respond in human language, rather than just following rigid, pre-programmed instructions. The key technologies that make this possible for the banking assistant include: Natural Language Processing (NLP): This allows the bot to understand the intent behind different ways a user might phrase the same request (e.g., "What is my balance?" vs. "How much money do I have left?"). Generative AI: This helps create helpful, human like responses based on the information the bot retrieves. Speech Recognition: This enables the bot to capture and process input given through voice, which is essential for creating a modern, accessible interface. By using Amazon Lex for this series, I am leveraging these technologies to move beyond simple, rule based systems and into the world of truly conversational AI.

How does Amazon Lex simplify chatbot development?

Building chatbots traditionally requires hiring specialized experts in machine learning, linguistics, and conversational design, which involves months of complex, expensive work. Amazon Lex simplifies this by handling the heavy lifting for me: * **Automated Infrastructure:** I don't need to manage servers or scale for users. * **Built-in NLP:** Lex manages natural language understanding.



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Excited to share my progress - build a chatbot with me!



